Lifeline Phone Program Update

(Information updated as of September 18, 2024)

The Lifeline Phone Program offered at Carnegie Resource Center, through Excess Telecom, has been TEMPORARILY PAUSED. Due to the high response to this in-person service and recent program changes, our Lifeline provider is continuing to experience a device shortage. They are utilizing this temporary pause to replenish their device inventory to ensure continued service continuity. Service is expected to resume by the second week in October.

We do not have information about the availability or whereabouts of other Lifeline providers in the area. Individuals are still able to visit https://www.lifelinesupport.org/companies-near-me/ to search for providers. Links to the provider websites from the search tool will be available so individuals can sign up for Lifeline service, if eligible.

Excess Telecom Program Changes

Many of the Lifeline Program providers have already transitioned to issuing SIM cards, with enrollment. Although individuals who met eligibility criteria may have also qualified for a device. Excess Telecom recently implemented this change in September. Eligible individuals will receive a SIM card with service enrollment, which will require the client to have a compatible unlocked device. Some individuals may still be able to receive a device; however, the representative will only be able to determine device eligibility status upon submission of the Lifeline application. Please understand device eligibility is not determined by the representative, rather the program itself. Representatives have no authority to change a decision generated and determined by the provider's eligibility criteria. Activation fees will still be required.